

Teaching Guide — Module 1, Segment 1: Welcome & Why Home Coffee (FULLY SHOWN)

The one artifact shown at full depth in this sample. Everything else in the folder is a stub. Compare to a stub to see “sketched” vs “done.”

This is the **gold tier** at the full anatomy of `1_Guide/templates/Teaching_Guide_Segment_TEMPLATE.md`: timed sub-blocks, inline stage cues, teaching tips, engagement questions, anticipated questions, a segment checklist with a hard timing checkpoint, instructor notes, and a verbatim transition. The floor tier for this same segment would be one agenda row plus three talking points.

Time: 0:00–0:15 (15 min) of a 90-min session. **Segment goal:** Lower the intimidation, give the one mental model the whole course hangs on, and state what they’ll be able to do today.

Segment objectives

- Students feel it’s OK to be a beginner (low-shame climate).
- Students can state the core model: **grind + water + ratio → extraction → taste.**
- Students know today’s goal: brew one good cup, on purpose.

Materials

- The instructor’s **reference brew** already made, kept warm, ready to taste (`Instructor_Materials/reference_brew/perfected_recipe_card.md`).
- Small tasting cups, one per student.
- Whiteboard for the one model.

Verbatim script

[0:00–0:04] Open on the shared failure

[STAND at the front, no slides yet]

“Welcome. Quick honesty: almost everyone has made a bad cup of coffee at home — too sour, too bitter, just blah. That’s not because you’re bad at it. It’s because nobody showed you the few levers that matter. Today I’ll show you the levers.”

[WAIT for responses – expect nods, maybe a laugh]

Teaching tip: say this one standing still and unhurried. The point of the first thirty seconds is that nobody in the room is about to be judged. If you rush it,

it reads as a formality and the anti-shame norm doesn't land.

Engagement question: *“Show of hands — who’s made a cup at home this week that disappointed them?”* Nearly every hand goes up, and that’s the point: they see they’re not the only one. Don’t make anyone explain it.

[0:04–0:08] The one model

[WRITE on board, large, and leave it up all session]

“Here’s the whole course on one line.” **“Grind + water + ratio → extraction → taste.”** “Everything we do — today and the next two sessions — is just adjusting one of those levers. That’s it.

By the end of *today*, you’ll have brewed one good cup of pour-over, on purpose, with a recipe you can repeat tomorrow.”

Teaching tip: write it, don’t slide it. Watching it appear makes it feel small and learnable; a pre-made slide makes it feel like curriculum. Leave it on the board — you will point at it a dozen times today, and every time you do you’re reinforcing that there are only three levers, not thirty.

Engagement question: *“Which of those three do you think you’ve been getting wrong?”* Take two or three answers, don’t correct any of them. You’re surfacing their priors so they have somewhere to attach today’s content — and you’ll often hear the exact misconception the module is built to fix.

[0:08–0:15] Taste the target

[HAND OUT small pours of the reference brew]

“First, taste this. This is the target. Notice it’s not bitter, not sour — it’s balanced and sweet. That’s what we’re aiming your cup at.”

[PAUSE — let them actually taste before saying anything else]

Teaching tip: silence here. The instinct is to narrate while they sip; don’t. They need one unhurried mouthful of “good” to calibrate against, and your voice competes with it. Then take reactions.

Engagement question: *“How is that different from what you usually make?”* The answers become your diagnostic vocabulary for Module 2 — when someone says “mine’s more bitter,” you can call back to it two sessions later.

Anticipated questions (with answers)

- “Do I need expensive gear?” → “A \$30 dripper, a scale, and a burr grinder get you 90% there. We’ll talk gear in a minute.”

- **“Is pre-ground coffee OK?”** → “It works, but freshness fades fast once ground. We’ll cover why — it’s the cheapest upgrade you can make.”
- **“What if I don’t taste the difference?”** → “That’s normal and it’s trainable — Module 2 is entirely about building that palate. Today just notice whether it’s pleasant.”

Segment checklist

- ☐ Reference brew made and still warm *before* students arrive.
- ☐ Tasting cups counted out, one per student.
- ☐ The one model written on the board, large, and left there.
- ☐ Anti-shame norm stated out loud, not just implied.
- ☐ Every student has actually tasted the reference cup.
- ☐ **Hard checkpoint: you are at 0:15.** If you’re past 0:18, cut the gear discussion in Segment 2 to compensate — do not borrow time from the brewing practice.

Instructor notes

- **Running long?** Drop the bad-coffee story and go straight to the model and the tasting. The tasting is the one thing in this segment that cannot be cut — it’s the benchmark the entire module compares against.
- **Running short?** Take one more round of tasting reactions, or ask what they currently use at home.
- **Energy:** this is the warmest segment of the day. Set the tone here and the room stays relaxed through the hands-on work, where people are most likely to feel clumsy.
- **Common pitfall:** instructors skip their own tasting cup. Taste it with them — it signals that you’re calibrating too, not grading them.

Transition to Segment 2

“You’ve tasted the target. Now let’s build the setup that gets you there — starting with the beans.” → Segment 2: Gear & Beans.